Thomas Lazarowicz

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Education

PhD in Economics, University College London — 2020–2027 (expected)
Committee: Vincent Sterk, Wei Cui, Franck Portier, Lukasz Rachel
MRes in Economics *(with Distinction)*, University College London — 2019–2020
MSc in Economics *(with Distinction)*, University College London — 2016–2017
MA in Economics *(First Class)*, University of Edinburgh — 2012–2016

Research Fields

Macroeconomics, Firm Dynamics, Monetary and Fiscal Policy.

Job Market Paper

Demand-Driven Stagnation: Customer Acquisition and Firm Growth

Peter Sinclair Prize for Best Paper, 13th MMF PhD Conference

What are the effects of a fiscal consolidation on firm growth, and do they depend on its distributional incidence? I study the UK's 2010–2015 austerity programme, whose welfare cuts fell mostly on low-income households. Young firms in more exposed local authorities cut customer acquisition by up to 15% per standard deviation relative to less exposed peers, while their employment, capacity utilisation and markups were unaffected. Young firms' value added fell and remained depressed through 2015, even after spending on customer acquisition recovered, suggesting a durable loss of customer base. Old firms showed no comparable adjustment. To explain why regressive shocks disproportionately scar young firms, I build a general equilibrium model in which firms accumulate customers from a heterogeneous-income population. Low-income customers churn faster, so young firms inherit a poor-biased customer base. This creates a "churn trap": young firms depend most on the households a regressive consolidation hits hardest. The effects are especially strong for firms that operate in 'luxury' sectors, whose demand is the most income-elastic. In the calibrated model, the 2010 austerity programme destroys about half as much again of young firms' customer capital as a progressive consolidation of the same size, and costs about nine pence more output per pound withdrawn than a progressive design, £11bn over the decade; the cohort entering during the shock remains persistently smaller than in the absence of the consolidation. A flat design would have avoided about a fifth of young firms' loss of customer capital, and a progressive design about three tenths.

Working Papers

Starting Over: The Cost of Fresh Starts and the Reallocation of Serial Entrepreneurs

Firms run by serial entrepreneurs are larger and more productive, yet little is known about how much aggregate output is lost because starting over is costly. I develop a firm-dynamics model in which entrepreneurs learn about their own ability and their business-specific match quality, and must liquidate and refinance to start over. I estimate the model on administrative data covering UK companies linked to their beneficial owners, which lets me follow entrepreneurs across the businesses they run. Two facts discipline the mechanism: within entrepreneurs, the serial productivity premium predates the switch to a new business, so it reflects selection on ability, not learning by doing; and exit rates fall with firm age, as entrepreneurs learn their ability in their first years. Because entrepreneurs learn slowly how good a match their business is, the most able wait years longer to start over than they would if they could see it. Removing the cost of starting over raises aggregate output by 2 percent and makes serial entrepreneurship the norm, with the gain coming from more firms, not better ones. For bankruptcy policy, recovering more of a failed firm's capital does more for output than cutting the cost of a fresh start by a quarter.

Monetary Transmission in a HANK Model with Housing and Rental Sectors,

with Daniel Albuquerque and Jamie Lenney
CFM Discussion Paper 2025-29

This paper develops a Heterogeneous Agent New Keynesian (HANK) model with housing and individual landlords to study how monetary policy transmits through and responds to housing and rental markets. Using new UK evidence we document that contractionary monetary policy generates a large, hump-shaped decline in house prices, while real rental prices increase mildly. We match the model to these facts and show how heterogeneity, real and behavioural frictions shape the response of rents and house prices to monetary policy. In turn rents and house prices become important for the transmission of monetary policy, and redistribute between renters, owners and landlords. Because a tightening modestly raises real rental prices, the model implies that policymakers should largely look through housing-driven inflation even under a headline inflation mandate.

Household Debt and Labour Supply,
with Phil Bunn, Jagjit Chadha, Stephen Millard and Emma Rockall
Bank of England Staff Working Paper No. 941, 2021

In this paper, we first develop a theoretical framework with three types of household: outright homeowners, mortgagors and renters. We then examine empirically how household debt affects the response of labour supply to shocks to income, mortgage interest rates and house prices for each type of household. In line with our framework, we find that negative income shocks lead to lower participation among outright homeowners while increasing mortgagors' desired hours; surprise rises in interest rates lead to increases in desired hours that are larger the higher is the household's debt level; and falls in house prices increase mortgagors' desired hours.

Work in Progress

Winners and Losers from Monetary Policy: Evidence from the UK Rental Market,
with Morgane Richard

Latent Demand Heterogeneity and Passthrough
with Federico Pessina and Dajana Xhani

Professional Experience

UCL MacroMonitor, PhD Analyst (nowcasting model development)	2025–present
Bank of England, PhD Intern, Monetary Policy Outlook Division, Modelling Unit	2024
University College London, Research Assistant to Wei Cui and Marta Morazzoni	2021–2024
Bank of England, Visiting Researcher (secondment)	2019
National Institute of Economic and Social Research, Macroeconomist	2017–2019

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, University College London

Advanced Macroeconomic Theory (MSc)	2025
Big Data Analytics (MSc)	2024–2025
Econometrics for Macroeconomics (Undergraduate)	2023–2024
Macroeconomic Theory and Policy (Undergraduate)	2020–2023
Time Series Econometrics (MSc)	2020–2022

Presentations (including scheduled)

2026: RES Annual Conference, EEA Annual Congress, HEC PhD Conference, MMF Annual Conference, MMF PhD Conference, QMUL PhD Workshop, UCL–Sciences Po Summer Workshop

2025: BoE–QMUL–Kent–Bristol Firm Dynamics Workshop, MMF Conference, MMF PhD Workshop, QMUL PhD Workshop

2024: Bank of England, ULB (ENTER Jamboree), Scottish Economic Society

Awards and Scholarships

Peter Sinclair Prize for Best Paper, 13th MMF PhD Conference	2026
PhD Scholarship, UCL Stone Centre on Wealth Concentration, Inequality, and the Economy	2022–2023
UCL Studentship	2020–Present
Economics Education Award, Best TA on a second-year module	2022 & 2023

Professional Service

Mentor, Cambridge, LSE, Oxford, Warwick and UCL Applicant Mentoring Programme	2021-2025
Conference Organiser, UCL Stone Centre PhD Conference	2024

Skills

Computational: Python, Matlab, Stata, Git
Data access: ONS Secure Research Service Accredited Researcher
Languages: English (native)

References

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